

To min-max or not to min-max?

Yes, yes, same old she-bang. Getting old, no time to game, one game at a time, yada yada yada. Broken record at this point. But hey, I could actually make a little booklet out of these editorials. "The ballad of the aging gamer" or something. Idk. Let me know I guess.

So, what's on the aging gamer's mind today? Min-maxing! I love min-maxing. What is min-maxing? Well, to put it simply, optimisation. Anyone who reads this editorial knows I love RPGs. I love min-maxing builds and optimising my characters because I love going on power trips and one-shooting anything I encounter in a game. The name of the game is DPS. Amirite?

Now, if you want to min-max, there's two ways to go about it. Through extensive personal experimentation and time investment, or, you follow the guide of someone who went through said extensive personal experimentation and time investment. Yeah, the second one may not be as fulfilling, but who has the time? Ageing gamer, remember?

Thing is, if you already have access to all this data, why not just use it? I remember having a similar discussion with Mithun aka Barbarian_Monkey 7 years ago, "Why have you played the Mass Effect trilogy only once?".

There's multiple endings and builds (albeit not as complex as some games out there); for context I've played the entire Mass Effect Trilogy at least 17 times. There's no

build or ending I haven't witnessed personally. Today, yeah, I'd probably do it once. I'd look up the best build, follow it to a T, and try to enjoy the game as much as I can in a single run. For the rest, there's always YouTube.

Which brings me to the final point about min-maxing. Saving time. Take Diablo 4 for example. I don't want to potentially waste my time by messing up my skill tree.

It doesn't have to be the absolute strongest build in the game, but I'd rather it be something viable from the get go. I don't have the time to back-pedal and fix s#!7. I'd rather this be a single, smooth, run. And I'll do everything in my power to make sure it's the best possible run ever, because I'm probably not coming back.

Same with a game like Genshin Impact. I'm going to look up the most efficient way to farm primos and I'm going to read up on character builds and items, because that's the best use of my time. I'm not going to run around the massive world and hope I come across what I need. That's just not me, and it's also, in my opinion, a waste of time.

In conclusion, min-maxing, good. If you don't min-max, you're bad. Just kidding, do what you find fun. If fun for you is floundering aimlessly in a game, you do you. I'll be here totally dominating this game I'm playing. *



Manish "Trigger-Happy" Rajesh

SKOAR! Overlord
feedback@skoar.in